

LUCA CASANO

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EDUCATION

Willamette University, Salem, OR

Master of Science in Data Science (3+1 Program)

Expected August 2026

Bachelor of Science in Data Science, Minor in Music

May 2026

SKILLS

Programming Languages : R, Python, Tidyverse, ggplot, dplyr, Numpy, Matplotlib, SQL

Data Analysis & Visualization : ggplot, Quarto, Matplotlib, EDA, Wrangling and Cleaning, Excel

Machine Learning : Linear Regression Models, Clustering

Tools & Libraries : Quarto, R Markdown, Github, Jupyter Notebook, Google Colab, VSCode, Tableau, PowerBI

RELEVANT PROJECT WORK

Willamette University Career Outcomes Analysis

Ongoing

- Develop a website-ready career outcomes dashboard in R, ggplot2, and Quarto that transforms post-graduation data into accessible visualizations for the Willamette University website.
- Analyze, gather, and clean institutional career outcomes data to produce accurate, publication-ready visualizations aligned with stakeholder-defined KPIs.
- Partner with cross-functional stakeholders across the Career Center, Admissions, and Institutional Research to gather requirements and translate business needs into effective data visualizations.
- Create reproducible data pipelines and documentation using R Markdown, Quarto to support efficient annual updates and long-term project maintenance.

Willamette Collegiate Tennis Accuracy Capstone

Ongoing

- Design and conduct a capstone research study investigating how incoming ball characteristics, stroke type, and fatigue influence shot accuracy in competitive tennis.
- Clean and analyze performance data in R using dplyr, ggplot2, and statistical hypothesis testing to identify trends and quantify factors affecting shot accuracy.
- Develop and evaluate machine learning classification models to identify the variables that most strongly predict shot accuracy and player performance.
- Build a reproducible data pipeline and analytical workflow from data collection through model evaluation to support scalable analysis across multiple participants.
- Communicate findings through interactive visualizations, a project website, research poster, and presentations, translating complex statistical and machine learning results for non-technical audiences.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Career Center - Career Outcomes Data Analytics Intern, Willamette University, Salem, OR

May 2026 - Present

- Build an accessible dashboard to display student outcomes data for internal and external audiences.
- Create data visualization assets that communicate the career center's reach and impact.
- Collaborate with cross-functional teams (Career Team, Institutional Research, and Alumni Relations) to define data needs and priorities.

Orchestra Assistant, Willamette University, Salem, OR

Jan 2025 - May 2026

- Maintain accurate data records for 30+ student instrument and locker rentals, ensuring accessibility and reducing errors in tracking system.
- Overhauled the department's paper-based instrument/locker tracking system by designing and implementing a digital workflow using Google Forms and Sheets, improving data accessibility and reducing record-keeping errors.

Music Department - Front Office Staff, Willamette University, Salem, OR

Sept 2022 - May 2026

- Support daily operations for a department serving 100+ students and faculty by managing schedules, communication, and event logistics with high attention to detail.
- Serve as the senior and longest-tenured student staff member, providing operational continuity and supporting onboarding for new hires.
- Trained two incoming supervisors on front-office systems, documentation practices, and event workflows, ensuring a smooth leadership transition and uninterrupted daily operations.

ACTIVITIES

- Willamette Men's Tennis, Willamette Volleyball Club, Punahou Varsity II Tennis Captain, Willamette Men's Tennis Social Media Manager
- Pacific Rim Symphony Orchestra, Mesrobian Memorial String Quartet, viola